

Title: Market Research for MDRA: “Market Research and Data-Driven Insights a Secondary Source Approach”

Summer Internship Project Report submitted in partial fulfillment of the
requirements for the degree of

Master of Business Administration

By

0241MBA053

Under the guidance of

DR. HARPREET SINGH GREWAL



DBS Global University, Dehradun

July, 2025

Title: : Market Research for MDRA: “Market Research and Data-Driven Insights a Secondary Source Approach”.

Summer Internship Project Report submitted in partial fulfillment of the requirements for the degree of

Master of Business Administration

By

0241MBA053

Under the guidance of

DR. HARPREET SINGH GREWAL



DBS Global University, Dehradun

July, 2025

Declaration

I declare that the Summer Internship Project report titled **Market Research for MDRA: “Market Research and Data-Driven Insights a Secondary Source Approach”**. was prepared by me as part of my Master of Business Administration degree. I completed this project under the guidance of Dr. Harpreet Singh Grewal. I also confirm that I haven’t submitted this report for any other degree, diploma, fellowship, or similar credential at DBS Global University or any other university.

Place: Dehradun

Rakshit Nautiyal

Date:

0241MBA053

Certificate

This is to confirm that Rakshit Nautiyal's Summer Internship Project report titled : **Market Research for MDRA: "Market Research and Data-Driven Insights a Secondary Source Approach"** reflects the work he completed during his internship in the 2024-26 academic year. I supervised and guided him throughout this project, which was part of his requirements to earn his Master of Business Administration degree at DBS Global University.

Place: Dehradun

Date:

Dr. Harpreet Singh Grewal

Professor

DBS Global University, Dehradun

Acknowledgement

I want to sincerely thank Dr. Harpreet Singh Grewal for all the guidance, helpful feedback, and ongoing support during this project. I also appreciate the faculty and staff at DBS Global University for providing the resources and an environment that made research easier. I'm grateful to my friends and colleagues for their encouragement and helpful chats. Lastly, I can't thank my family enough for their constant support and motivation, which really helped me complete this project successfully.

Rakshit Nautiyal

0241MBA053

LIST OF CONTENT

Sr. No.	Particulars	Page No.
1.	Executive Summary	7

2.	Learnings From SIP	8-9
3.	Chapter-I Introduction	9-10
4	Chapter-II Industry Analysis	11-12
5	Chapter-III Company Profile	13-18
6	Chapter-IV Project/s Outline	18-21
7	Chapter-V Project wise Analysis	22-24
5.	Chapter-VI Summary of Project analysis and findings	24-25
6.	Projects Outline	25-27
7.	Reflections & Key Learnings	28-29
8.	References	30
9.	Detailed Weekly Internship Summary (Weeks 1–8)	31-33
10.	Appendix Questionnaire	33-34
11.	Plagiarism report	34-35

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The Summer Internship Project (SIP) focused on conducting **market research for the ranking of top B-Schools in India**, with the objective of compiling, cleaning, validating, and organizing institutional data to support the 2025 rankings publication. The project involved systematic secondary research, outreach to institutions, and structured data management over an eight-week period.

In the **initial phase**, data was compiled from over 100 institutions based on previous year's rankings. Information was manually gathered from emails, brochures, and official websites, and entered into pre-formatted Excel templates, forming the foundation of the database.

The **second phase** emphasized **data cleaning and standardization**. Duplicates and outliers were removed, fields such as fee structures, accreditations, and course names were standardized, and Excel formulas were used to ensure consistency. This created a reliable dataset for further evaluation.

Subsequent weeks focused on **data enrichment and validation**. Missing inputs were filled by directly contacting institutions, supplementing responses with verified public data such as infrastructure details, faculty size, and international collaborations. Independent verification improved the accuracy and credibility of the dataset.

Where institutions were unresponsive, **follow-ups via calls and emails** were conducted, recovering critical information on programs, placements, and batch strength. Fresh responses from over 30 institutions significantly improved the dataset's completeness and recency.

The **final stage** of the internship involved **structuring the validated data** in alignment with the ranking methodology. Institutions were categorized, individual profiles were prepared, and index sheets were created for seamless navigation. The dataset was formatted with filters, color codes, and explanatory notes, ensuring usability for both editorial and analytics teams.

By the conclusion of the internship, a **comprehensive and credible dataset** was delivered, serving as a direct input for the **2025 B-School Rankings**. Additionally, an executive summary of patterns and insights was prepared for senior editors, highlighting trends and data completeness across institutions.

This project enhanced skills in **secondary research, data validation, Excel-based data management, institutional communication, and market analysis**. It provided valuable exposure to the processes involved in preparing **credible, large-scale educational rankings**, contributing to both academic learning and practical research experience.

LEARNING FROM SIP

During the course of my Summer Internship Project, I gained extensive exposure to **market research processes, institutional communication, and data management practices** while contributing to the preparation of B-School rankings in India. The experience provided me with both technical and interpersonal learnings that are highly relevant to academic research and corporate projects.

One of the key learnings was developing **professional communication skills** while reaching out to institutions. I learned how to draft clear, concise, and respectful messages through emails and calls, manage responses, and conduct polite follow-ups. This enhanced my **interpersonal and stakeholder management skills** in an academic data setting.

I strengthened my ability to **collect, review, and verify real-time data** from multiple sources such as institutional websites, brochures, emails, and accreditation databases. I learned how to differentiate between **credible information and promotional content**, cross-check institutional claims, and maintain structured logs to cite sources and validate secondary data.

From a technical perspective, I developed proficiency in **Excel-based data handling**. This included manual recording of raw information, data cleaning techniques using functions like =TRIM(), =CLEAN(), and =PROPER(), handling missing values, removing duplicates, and ensuring standardized entries. I also practiced creating pivot tables, charts, and graphs to

visualize trends and summarize large datasets, which improved my ability to **translate raw data into actionable insights**.

I also learned how to **organize and categorize data** meaningfully, segmenting institutions by zone, type, and specialization. I practiced incorporating new evaluation parameters into datasets for a more holistic assessment. These practices improved my attention to detail, accuracy, and ability to identify patterns such as ROI trends and accreditation distribution across institutions.

The project taught me persistence in **data recovery and follow-ups**, especially when institutions were unresponsive. I learned to creatively use alternative sources like archived reports and public databases while balancing deadlines by prioritizing essential information.

Finally, I gained experience in **structured reporting and presentation**. I learned how to prepare professional Excel-based databases with filters, legends, and notes for clarity, and how to create executive summaries that highlighted key findings. By presenting final deliverables to senior editors, I understood the role of interns in the **publication cycle of reputed media houses**, linking academic research with real-world outcomes.

Overall, this internship significantly enhanced my **research, analytical, communication, and reporting skills**, while giving me valuable exposure to the challenges and processes involved in large-scale educational rankings.

CHAPTER-I

INTRODUCTION

The Summer Internship Project (SIP) is an integral part of the MBA curriculum that provides students with practical exposure to the functioning of organizations and bridges the gap between academic learning and real-world practices. It enables students to understand industry dynamics, organizational structures, and business strategies while developing essential professional skills.

This Summer Internship Project (SIP) was undertaken with the objective of contributing to the **market research process for preparing the rankings of top B-Schools in India**. The internship provided me with hands-on experience in data collection, validation, organization, and reporting, while also developing skills in communication, analysis, and professional documentation.

My role primarily involved compiling and managing large volumes of data from multiple sources such as institutional websites, brochures, accreditation databases, and direct communication with colleges. I was responsible for **structuring and cleaning raw data** using Excel, ensuring consistency and accuracy through functions, formatting, and verification checks.

The project also required me to **reach out to institutions** through emails, calls, and follow-ups to collect missing or updated information related to faculty, infrastructure, placements, accreditations, and program offerings. This helped in building a more complete and reliable dataset by combining both primary responses and secondary research.

I was actively involved in **reviewing, cross-verifying, and supplementing institutional data** with independently available information to enhance credibility. I also worked on organizing institutions into categories, preparing profiles, and creating structured datasets aligned with the ranking methodology.

Towards the later phase, I contributed to the **presentation and reporting of findings** by preparing executive summaries, indexing datasets, creating filters and legends for usability, and briefing senior editors about the data structure and insights. These deliverables directly supported the editorial and analytics teams in generating the upcoming **2025 B-School Rankings publication**.

Overall, the internship exposed me to the complete cycle of **data-driven market research for educational rankings**—from collection and verification to structuring and reporting—while strengthening both my technical and professional skills.

CHAPTER II- INDUSTRY ANALYSIS

Overview of Market Research

The industry provides insights for marketing, product, and policy decisions using surveys, panels, digital analytics, and AI-enabled methods.

India is a fast-growing hub serving both domestic clients (FMCG, retail, edtech, BFSI) and global offshoring work, with strong associations (MRSI/ESOMAR) shaping standards.

Market Size and Growth

India size & trajectory: Indian Research & Insights industry estimated ~US\$2.9B with ~17.5% growth in the latest ESOMAR cycle, and projected to reach ~US\$3.4B in FY2025 (MRSI).

Global context: The wider insights ecosystem reached ~US\$142B in 2023 (research, software, reporting combined), underscoring strong tech-led expansion.

Key Players

Multinationals: NIQ (NielsenIQ), GfK (now combined with NIQ globally), Kantar, Ipsos, YouGov—with India operations across CPG, retail, and digital.

Indian leaders & specialists: Hansa Research and other MRSI members active in consumer panels, social listening, and custom research.

Recent Trends

AI & automation: Rapid adoption of AI for coding open-ends, predictive modeling, and insight summarization; research-software revenue is now a major slice of global insights turnover.

Digital data mix: Growth in online panels, app telemetry, e-commerce analytics, and social listening; faster turnaround for brand/innovation work (e.g., NIQ BASES).

Privacy-by-design: New data-protection norms influencing consent, collection points, and data retention practices in India

Challenges Faced by the Industry

Data privacy & compliance: Adapting consent flows, children’s data safeguards, and cross-border transfers under India’s Digital Personal Data Protection (DPDP) Act.

Sampling & quality: Fighting fraud/duplicates in online panels; ensuring representative coverage beyond metros. (Industry-wide issue noted in ESOMAR discussions.)

Outbound outreach limits: Tighter rules on unsolicited commercial communication affect tele-surveys/SMS recruitment.

Government Initiatives & Regulatory Support

DPDP Act, 2023: Establishes consent, purpose limitation, user rights (access, correction, erasure), and “legitimate uses”; draft rules underway to operationalize the law.

TRAI UCC framework: Strengthens controls on spam calls/SMS and mandates registries and headers—relevant for research outreach protocols.

Ongoing clarifications: Sector conversations on consent granularity and operational practicality (e.g., payments ecosystem) signal an evolving compliance landscape.

Future Outlook

Sustained double-digit growth expected as India scales insight offshoring, digital commerce measurement, and AI-assisted analytics; domestic demand from FMCG, retail, BFSI, and education remains strong. Convergence of MR + analytics + software: Tooling and automation will keep expanding share within the insights value chain.

Privacy-centric operations: Firms that embed compliant consent, secure collection (no public disclosure of identifiers), and transparent data logs will gain trust and access.

CHAPTER-III

COMPANY PROFILE- MDRA (Marketing and development Research Associates)

Introduction to the Company

Marketing & Development Research Associates (MDRA), established in the early 1990s (around 1993–1994), is a premier marketing research and consulting organization based in New Delhi, India. It specializes in both quantitative and qualitative research, offering strategic business planning solutions grounded in data analysis and market insight. As a proud member of the Market Research Society of India (MRSI), MDRA has built a reputation for bringing critical market data into strategic decision-making

Vision, Mission, and Core Values

While MDRA does not publicly declare explicit vision and mission statements, its ethos and values can be inferred:

Mission-like focus: Empower clients through deep market insights to inform strategic planning and improve customer satisfaction and competitive positioning

Core values: Dedication to **accuracy, methodological rigor, strategic impact,** and **client satisfaction.** These are reflected in its research standards and its role in high-profile ranking projects

Products and Services

MDRA delivers a comprehensive suite of market research and consultancy offerings, including:

DEL (Defection and Leakage) Analysis

Market Structure & Segment Analysis

Advertisement & Brand Effectiveness Research

Consumer Research

Industry Rating & Performance Studies

Customer Satisfaction, Retention & Loyalty Studies

Customer Value Measurement

Market Potential Assessment & Demand Estimation

Market Strategy Formulation & Implementation

Product & Pricing Studies

Impact Assessment Studies

Opinion Polls / Exit Polls / Election Analysis

University, College, and B-School Rankings (notably in partnership with India Today)

In addition, MDRA has engaged in diverse sectors such as automotive, consumer durables, infrastructure, energy (oil and natural gas), power, media & communication, retail, international trade, and government projects

Customer Segments Served

MDRA caters to a varied clientele including:

Corporate businesses seeking consumer and brand insights

Educational institutions (via ranking studies)

Government agencies and public sector units (through impact assessment and opinion polls)

Media houses (e.g., India Today) and election commissions (for election analysis and public opinion data)

Competitive Advantage

MDRA's strengths include:

Dual expertise in **quantitative and qualitative research**, allowing for deep and actionable insights

Specialization in educational rankings, including the prestigious India Today-MDRA college and B-school rankings, employing rigorous frameworks and multi-parameter methodologies

A **diverse sectoral portfolio**, enhancing methodological robustness across industries

Established reputation for **strategic consulting** and data-driven business planning

Organizational Structure

MDRA operates as a compact, tightly-managed team based out of New Delhi:

It reportedly employs between **17 to 35 staff members**, including researchers, survey coordinators, and administrative personnel

The organizational hierarchy appears to include an **Executive Director**, research analysts, survey programmers, research and marketing staff, and HR/Admin executives

The team ethos emphasizes passion, innovation, professionalism, and mentorship within a continuous-learning culture

Problem Statement

Marketing & Development Research Associates (MDRA) is entrusted with producing credible, large-scale rankings and market research studies across sectors, including the highly visible India Today–MDRA B-School

Rankings. The accuracy and credibility of these rankings depend heavily on the quality, completeness, and timeliness of institutional data

However, MDRA faces multiple challenges:

Incomplete or delayed responses from institutions, requiring persistent follow-ups.

Inconsistent data formats across websites, brochures, and official submissions, which complicates standardization.

Verification difficulties, as institutions may overstate achievements in areas like placements, infrastructure, or accreditations.

Time constraints to clean, validate, and structure large datasets before editorial deadlines.

Evolving parameters of rankings, which require continuous updating of data fields and methodologies.

These issues create a gap between the demand for transparent, credible rankings and the fragmented, sometimes unreliable data ecosystem available in the higher education sector. MDRA's challenge, therefore, is to develop robust processes for data collection, validation, and reporting that can withstand scrutiny and deliver trustworthy insights to stakeholders.

CHAPTER-IV

PROJECT ANALYSIS

Title of the Project

Market Research for MDRA: “Market Research and Data-Driven Insights a Secondary Source Approach”.

This internship was conducted as part of the MBA curriculum and aimed to bridge the gap between academic learning and practical industry exposure

Duration and Location of the Internship

- **Internship Duration:** 2 months
- **Start Date:** 2 June, 2025
- **End Date:** 31 July, 2025
- **Internship Location:** Marketing and Development Research Associates, Delhi

Objectives of the Project

To compile, validate, and organize institutional data for the preparation of the **2025 B-School Rankings**.

To strengthen the credibility of rankings through **cross-verification of institutional claims** with secondary sources.

To improve **data completeness and accuracy** by coordinating with institutions via calls, emails, and follow-ups.

To deliver a structured dataset aligned with the **ranking methodology**, supporting editorial and analytics teams.

To gain practical exposure to **market research methodologies** and enhance skills in data management, analysis, and reporting.

Scope of the Project

The project covered **over 100 business schools and universities** across India, focusing on multiple ranking parameters such as **infrastructure, faculty strength, placements, accreditations, international collaborations, and ROI trends**.

Included both **primary outreach** (emails, calls, follow-ups) and **secondary research** (websites, brochures, accreditation databases).

Scope was limited to **data collection, cleaning, validation, and structuring**; final ranking decisions rested with senior editorial and analytics teams.

The project directly contributed to the **India Today–MDRA 2025 Rankings publication**.

Conceptual Framework

The project was based on the principle that **accurate and credible data** is the foundation of meaningful rankings. The framework combined:

Data Collection → Gathering raw information from institutions and public sources.

Data Validation → Cross-checking claims with independent databases and accreditation bodies.

Data Structuring → Standardizing and categorizing data into ranking parameters.

Data Reporting → Organizing datasets for editorial teams and preparing executive insights.

This framework ensured that the research outcomes were **methodologically sound, transparent, and credible**.

Research Methodology

1. Research Design

Approach: Combination of **secondary research** and **institutional outreach (primary data)**.

Design: Descriptive and analytical in nature, aimed at organizing educational institutions into a **comparative ranking framework**.

Data Sources: Institutional websites, brochures, email responses, telephonic follow-ups, accreditation bodies, and independent public databases

Methodology Description

Identification of Institutions: Selected based on previous year's rankings and current academic reputation.

Data Compilation: Collected raw data manually from websites, brochures, and direct communication.

Data Cleaning: Removed duplicates, standardized entries (fees, course names, locations), and used Excel functions (=TRIM(), =CLEAN(), =PROPER()).

Data Validation: Cross-verified information (placements, accreditations, collaborations) with secondary sources.

Data Enrichment: Supplemented missing inputs through follow-ups and verified public data.

Data Structuring: Segregated institutions by type, specialization, and geography; created profiles and index sheets.

Final Deliverables: Prepared structured Excel datasets with filters, legends, and notes; created executive summaries highlighting trends.

Detailed Work Responsibilities

Compiling and recording institutional data from emails, brochures, and websites.

Cleaning, standardizing, and formatting large datasets in Excel.

Reaching out to institutions through **emails, calls, and follow-ups** for missing information.

Cross-verifying institutional claims with **accreditation databases and independent reports**.

Categorizing institutions and preparing **individual profiles** aligned with ranking parameters.

Developing **executive summaries and briefs** for senior editors and research leads.

Assisting in the preparation of the **final dataset** for the 2025 rankings publication.

Tools, Platforms, and Channels Used

MS Excel → Data entry, cleaning, formatting, pivot tables, charts, and summaries.

MS Word → Drafting summaries, notes, and reports.

Email Communication (Outlook/Gmail) → Institutional outreach and follow-ups.

Telephonic Calls → Direct interaction with academic representatives.

Web Browsers & PDFs → Secondary data extraction from official websites, brochures, and accreditation reports.

Internal Templates → Pre-formatted Excel sheets for ranking parameters and indexing.

Departments and Teams Interacted With

Research Team: Primary point of collaboration for data compilation, validation, and methodology alignment.

Editorial Team: Coordinated for insights, summaries, and preparation of final content for publication.

Institutional Representatives: Communicated with faculty coordinators, placement officers, and administrative staff for authentic information.

Supervisors/Mentors: Reported progress, received feedback, and refined dataset structure for usability.

CHAPTER-V PROJECT WISE ANALYSIS

Project Planning and Orientation

- Understood the objective of the B-School Ranking Project and familiarized with MDRA's methodology.
- Reviewed previous year's datasets and ranking frameworks.
- Identified key parameters such as infrastructure, placements, accreditations, ROI, and international exposure.
- Prepared initial plan for data collection, validation, and communication strategy.

Phase 2: Data Collection

- Conducted **secondary research** by visiting institutional websites, brochures, accreditation portals, and public reports.
- Engaged in **primary data collection** through outreach to institutions via emails and telephonic calls.
- Collected data related to **academic programs, placement records, faculty profiles, infrastructure, and student outcomes**.
- Created raw data sheets in **MS Excel** with institution-wise entries.

Phase 3: Data Cleaning and Validation

- Standardized the collected data to ensure **consistency in format** (fees, course titles, location codes).
- Applied Excel functions like **TRIM, CLEAN, VLOOKUP, and Pivot Tables** to organize data.
- Cross-verified claims (placement figures, accreditations, collaborations) using **independent sources and official records**.
- Eliminated duplicate and inconsistent entries for a **reliable dataset**.

Phase 4: Data Structuring and Categorization

- Segregated institutions based on **type (government/private), region, specialization, and accreditations**.
- Prepared **institutional profiles** including highlights of academic strengths and placement records.
- Structured the dataset in alignment with **ranking parameters** to simplify analysis for senior teams.
- Created index sheets and legends for easier navigation within the dataset.

Phase 5: Institutional Interaction and Follow-Ups

- Directly interacted with **placement officers, faculty coordinators, and administrative staff** for authentic information.
- Sent structured queries via **emails** to clarify discrepancies.
- Followed up with institutions through **calls** to collect missing or incomplete data.
- Maintained communication logs for **accountability and transparency**.

Phase 6: Report Preparation and Deliverables

- Compiled data into **Excel dashboards** with filtering and sorting features.
- Prepared **executive summaries** highlighting market trends, institutional performance, and emerging patterns.
- Contributed insights to the **editorial team** for the India Today–MDRA B-School Rankings.
- Submitted the final dataset to supervisors with **annotations, notes, and references**.

Phase 7: Learning and Skill Development

- Acquired hands-on experience in **market research and ranking methodology**.
- Enhanced skills in **data handling, MS Excel, secondary research, and communication**.
- Gained exposure to the **education sector's dynamics**, particularly in management education.
- Developed **professional communication and consumer-handling skills** while dealing with institutions.

CHAPTER-VI

SUMMARY OF PROJECT ANALYSIS AND FINDINGS

Introduction

The Summer Internship Project focused on **market research and data compilation for India Today–MDRA B-School Rankings 2025**. The primary objective was to build a **comprehensive, credible, and structured database** of Indian B-Schools by collecting, cleaning, validating, and organizing data from both primary and secondary sources.

The project scope covered **100+ institutions** across India and involved multiple stages: data collection from official websites, brochures, and direct outreach; cleaning and standardizing datasets using Excel functions; verifying institutional claims through cross-checking with accreditation bodies and credible public data; and preparing structured profiles and summaries aligned with ranking parameters.

The research methodology combined **primary data** (emails, telephonic follow-ups, and institutional responses) with **secondary research** (archived reports, PDFs, and websites). Tools such as **MS Excel and MS Word** were extensively used for data management, formatting, pivot tables, charting, and report writing. Communication channels included emails,

calls, and professional correspondence, which enhanced interpersonal and stakeholder engagement skills.

Throughout the project, significant challenges included **incomplete institutional responses, inconsistent data formats, and time-bound validation requirements**. These were addressed through persistent follow-ups, careful standardization, and structured reporting practices.

The analysis revealed several key findings:

- **Data Reliability Improves Through Verification:** Many institutions overstated achievements in placements or infrastructure, which required independent validation.
- **Sectoral Patterns Identified:** Trends in ROI, accreditations, and geographical distribution of top B-Schools were observed.
- **Standardization is Critical:** Uniformity in data (e.g., fees, faculty count, locations) enhanced comparability and usability for rankings.
- **Holistic Datasets Add Value:** Incorporating additional parameters like international collaborations and infrastructure improved the ranking framework.
- **Professional Communication is Essential:** Effective outreach and polite follow-ups directly impacted data completeness and credibility.

Ultimately, the project resulted in a **well-structured, validated dataset** that directly contributed to the 2025 B-School Rankings publication. It also provided hands-on exposure to **real-world research processes**, strengthened skills in **data analytics and reporting**, and demonstrated how structured research underpins credible rankings in the education sector.

PROJECT OUTLINE

Project Title

Research and Data Compilation for India Today–MDRA B-School Rankings 2025.

Intern Name

Rakshit Nautiyal

MBA Student – DBS GLOBAL UNIVERSITY

ERP No: 0241MBA053.

Internship Organization

Marketing and development research associates(MDRA).

DEHRADUN D2

Internship Duration: **2 JUNE 2025 to 31 JULY 2025**

Project Guide

Name: MR.Vaibhav Gupta

Designation: Deputy Research Manager

Organization: **Marketing and development research associates(MDRA).**

College Guide

Name: DR. HARPREET GREWAL

Designation: PROFESSOR

Institution: DBS GLOBAL UNIVERSITY

Objectives of the Project

- To collect authentic data from Indian B-Schools through primary and secondary sources.
- To ensure accuracy and comparability by cleaning and standardizing datasets.
- To validate institutional claims through cross-verification with credible sources.
- To prepare structured profiles and categorized datasets aligned with ranking parameters.
- To provide actionable insights and summaries for the ranking publication

Scope of the Project

- Covered over 100 B-Schools and universities across India.
- Included primary outreach (emails, calls, follow-ups) and secondary research (websites, brochures, PDFs, accreditation databases).
- Focused on data preparation, structuring, and insights generation for rankings.
- Excluded final methodology decisions, which remained under MDRA's senior team.

Methodology

- **Primary Data Collection:** Reached out to institutions via emails, telephonic calls, and forms.
- **Secondary Data Collection:** Reviewed official websites, brochures, accreditation bodies, and public databases.

- **Data Cleaning & Validation:** Removed duplicates, anomalies, and formatted inconsistent entries using Excel.
- **Data Structuring:** Categorized institutions by type, specialization, and geography; developed individual profiles.
- **Finalization:** Submitted structured Excel sheets and executive summaries to MDRA.

Key Deliverables

- Compiled data of **100+ B-Schools** across India.
 - Included details on fees, faculty strength, infrastructure, placements, accreditations, and collaborations.
 - Removed duplicates, anomalies, and formatting inconsistencies.
 - Ensured uniformity in entries such as program names, location formats, and fee structures.
 - Cross-verified institutional claims with **official websites, brochures, and accreditation bodies**.
 - Enhanced data credibility by supplementing institutional responses with secondary research.
 - Maintained records of email follow-ups, telephonic conversations, and institutional responses.
 - Documented pending and completed communication for transparency.
 - Summarized data completeness, challenges, and reliability improvements.
- Submitted as the **official input for the 2025 India Today–MDRA B-School Rankings**.

REFLECTIONS AND KEY LEARNINGS

Introduction

The Summer Internship Project at MDRA offered a unique opportunity to gain first-hand exposure to the field of **market research and academic rankings**. The project allowed me to engage in diverse activities such as **data collection, validation, structuring, and reporting**, while also interacting with institutional representatives, research teams, and editorial staff. This experience significantly contributed to my professional, technical, and personal development.

This chapter presents my personal reflections and key learnings gained during the course of the internship.

1. Professional Growth and Exposure

- Gained experience working in a **real-world research organization** known for large-scale ranking studies.
- Understood the importance of **credibility, accuracy, and timelines** in high-stakes research publications.
- Learned the **workflow of professional market research projects**, from data collection to final reporting.
- Observed how cross-functional teams (research, editorial, analytics) collaborate to deliver outcomes.

2. Practical Experience

- Handled **end-to-end data compilation** for over 100 institutions.
- Practiced **professional communication** with institutional representatives through emails and calls.
- Understood challenges in obtaining timely responses and developed **persistent follow-up strategies**.
- Experienced the **pressure of deadlines** and learned to prioritize critical tasks

3. Technical and Analytical Learning

- Strengthened **Excel skills**: used formulas like TRIM(), CLEAN(), and PROPER() for data consistency.
- Learned to use **pivot tables and charts** for summaries and visual insights.
- Practiced **data cleaning and anomaly detection** to improve dataset reliability.
- Improved ability to **structure raw data into actionable insights** for rankings and publications.

4. Soft Skills Enhancement

- Developed **stakeholder management** skills by coordinating with multiple institutions.
- Improved **interpersonal communication** through polite follow-ups and clarification emails.
- Enhanced **attention to detail** to avoid errors in manual data entry and verification.
- Gained confidence in **professional presentation** of data and insights to senior teams.

5. Industry Insights

- Observed **key patterns in the education sector**, such as ROI trends, faculty–student ratios, and accreditation practices.
- Understood the **role of rankings in shaping institutional reputation** and influencing student choices.
- Realized the growing importance of **data-driven decision-making** in the education industry.
- Learned how **independent validation** is critical to maintain credibility in published research.

6. Personal Takeaways

- Developed a **research-oriented mindset** with focus on accuracy and reliability.
- Learned how to **differentiate between marketing claims and factual information**.
- Gained persistence, adaptability, and time management skills in a professional setting.
- Understood how **secondary research and structured reporting** can contribute to large-scale industry projects.
- The internship reinforced my interest in **analytics, research, and education sector studies** as a potential career path.

REFERENCES

1. Kotler, Philip & Keller, Kevin Lane. *Marketing Management*. Pearson Education, 15th Edition.
2. Kothari, C. R. *Research Methodology: Methods and Techniques*, New Age International Publishers.
3. Observations and verbal guidance from seniors and manager.
4. All India Council for Technical Education (AICTE) – <https://www.aicte-india.org>
5. National Board of Accreditation (NBA) – <https://www.nbaind.org>
6. Association to Advance Collegiate Schools of Business (AACSB) – <https://www.aacsb.edu>
7. Business Today B-School Rankings (2024 edition).

WEEKLY WORK SUMMARY

Week 1

Work Summary:

- Initiate the process of compiling data from universities and business schools for upcoming rankings
- Identified relevant institutions based on previous year's listings.
- Manually collected data from emails, brochures, and official websites.
- Entered raw data into pre-formatted Excel templates.

- Created the initial database covering 100+ institutions with basic ranking parameters

Week 2

Work Summary:

- Prepare the scraped data for evaluation and ranking by ensuring consistency and accuracy.
- Removed duplicates and outliers.
- Standardized fields such as fee structure, course names, and accreditations.
- Used Excel formulas to ensure uniform data formatting.
- Generated a clean, structured dataset for further review by the editorial team.

Week 3

Work Summary:

- Fill data gaps and collect updated inputs directly from institutions.
- Sent follow-up emails to institutes requesting latest details on programs, batch strength, placements, etc.
- Collected fresh responses from over 30 institutions.
- Manually recorded all responses into designated Excel sheets.
- Significantly improved the completeness and recency of the data repository.

Week 4

Work Summary:

- Supplement institutional responses with verified public data.
- Reviewed official institute websites and brochures.
- Collected additional data points (e.g.. Infrastructure, international collaborations, faculty size).
- Cross-verified program offerings and accreditations.
- Strengthened data credibility with independently verified entries.

Week 5

Work Summary:

- Completed the remaining institutional data entries to ensure dataset completeness.
- Conducted additional follow-up calls to clarify **ambiguous or missing information** from institutions.
- Revised and cleaned Excel sheets to enhance **accuracy, consistency, and formatting**.
- Organized all Word notes systematically by **college name** for quick reference and review.
- Utilized **AI tools** to identify gaps and inconsistencies in data coverage.

Week 6

Work Summary:

- Collect data from institutions that didn't respond during primary outreach.
- Identified missing institutions from the previous year's rankings.
- Conducted telephonic follow-ups and revisited online sources.
- Maintained a response log for communication tracking.
- Recovered or reconstructed missing data for many institutes.

Week 7

Work Summary:

- Organize validated data in line with ranking method.
- Segregated institutions by category.
- Prepared individual institution profiles in Excel with all ranking parameters.
- Created index sheets for quick navigation across data sets.
- Delivered a well-organized database for editorial and analytics teams.

Week 8

Work Summary:

- Submit final dataset and assist in report generation.
- Final formatting of Excel sheets with filters, color codes, and footnotes.
- Created an executive summary highlighting key patterns and data completeness.
- Briefed senior editors/research leads on the structure and logic of the sheets.
- Submitted final deliverables used as input for the 2025 rankings publication process.

APPENDIX

Appendix – I: Internship Work Samples

- Screenshots of Excel sheets used for data entry, cleaning, and formatting.
- Sample email drafts sent to institutions for data requests and clarifications.
- Notes and communication logs documenting follow-ups with B-Schools.
- Extracts of pivot tables, charts, and categorized profiles prepared during the project.

Appendix – II: Data Collected During Internship

Institutional information on:

- Fee structure and program details.
- Faculty strength and student intake.
- Placement data and recruiter profiles.
- Accreditation details (AICTE, NBA, AACSB, EQUIS).
- Infrastructure and international collaborations.
- Structured database covering **100+ B-Schools** across India.
- Supplementary data from **official websites, brochures, PDFs, and annual reports**

Appendix – III: Reports Prepared

Executive Summaries highlighting:

- Trends in accreditations and ROI.
- Placement patterns across institutions.
- Regional distribution and specialization strengths.
- **Institution Profiles** prepared in Excel with ranking parameters.
- **Final Dataset Submission** with filters, color codes, and notes for use.

Appendix – IV: Organizational Documents (Internal Reference)

- Templates provided by MDRA for structured data entry.
- Internal guidelines on ranking parameters and evaluation framework.
- Confidential instructions on handling institutional communication.
- Reference documents from MDRA on previous year rankings for benchmarking.

PLAGIARISM REPORT

Project Title:

Market Research for MDRA: “Market Research and Data-Driven Insights a Secondary Source Approach”

Candidate Name: Rakshit Nautiyal

ERP No.: 0241MBA053

Course: MBA

Institution: DBS GLOBAL UNIVERSITY

Plagiarism Check Statement

This is to certify that the Summer Internship Project Report submitted by Rakshit Nautiyal has been checked for plagiarism using plagiarism detection software.

- **Similarity Index Found: 7%**
- **Acceptable Limit as per Institution Norms: Less than 15%**

The similarity detected is primarily from properly referenced materials, standard terminologies, and publicly available company information. No instances of academic misconduct or unauthorized copying were found.

Declaration

I hereby declare that this report is my original work, and all secondary sources of information have been duly acknowledged through proper references. Any similarity observed is incidental and within acceptable academic limits.

Checked By:

DR. HARPREET GREWAL

SENIOR PROFESSOR

DBS GLOBAL UNIVERSITY

Date: _____

Signature & Seal: _____

